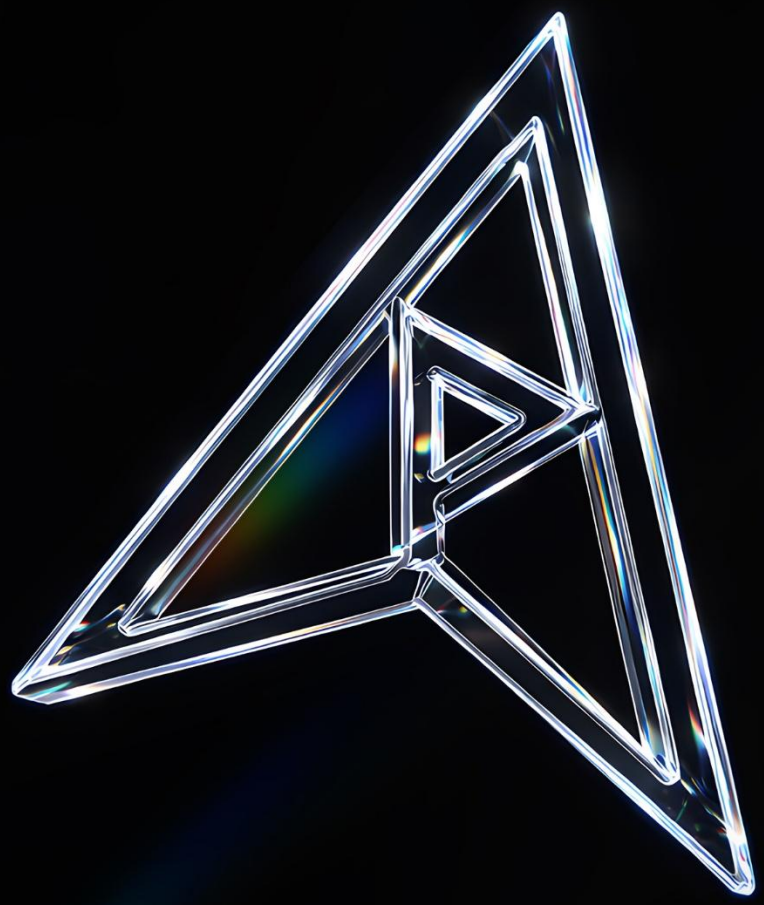
PAPERPLANES LLP

HR POLICY HANDBOOK 2026



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Applicability: All full time employees, probationary employees, and interns

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1. INTRODUCTION & SCOPE

This HR Policy Handbook outlines the policies, procedures, and guidelines governing employment at **Paperplanes LLP**. The purpose of this handbook is to ensure clarity, fairness, and consistency while maintaining flexibility suited to a growing organization.

This handbook serves as a guiding document and does not constitute a contract of employment. The company reserves the right to amend, modify, or withdraw any policy at its discretion.

2. EMPLOYMENT CATEGORIES

- **Probationary Employees** – Employees undergoing an initial evaluation period.
- **Confirmed Employees** – Employees confirmed after successful completion of probation.
- **Interns** – Individuals engaged for learning and skill development for a fixed duration.

3. WORKING HOURS & ATTENDANCE

- Working days: Monday to Friday (5 days/week)
- Official working hours: 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM
- Lunch break: 1:00 PM – 2:00 PM
- Evening break: 4:00 PM – 4:20 PM

Note: As a creative organization, reasonable flexibility may be required based on project needs. Employees are expected to complete assigned responsibilities within normal working hours.

Attendance must be recorded daily as per company practice.

4. LEAVE POLICY

Paperplanes LLP encourages work life balance and supports employee wellness through a structured leave policy. All leaves must be requested via the appropriate internal communication channels and approved by the reporting authority.

- Leave requests must be submitted in the prescribed **leave request format** via **email to HR**.
- Leaves may be taken **only after approval** is received from the reporting authority.

4.1 Casual Leave (CL)

- 1 day credited per month
- **Prior approval is required for all leave requests, except in genuine emergency situations; Casual Leave (CL) must be applied for at least two (2) days in advance.**

4.2 Sick Leave (SL)

- Up to 12 paid sick leaves per year
- Medical certificate required for sick leave exceeding 2 consecutive days

4.3 Unpaid Leave (UL)

- Applicable only after exhaustion of paid leaves
- Subject to management approval

4.4 Compensatory Off

Employees working on weekends or holidays may be eligible for compensatory leave, subject to reporting and approval.

4.5 Late arrival / Early departure

Late arrival or early departure on a frequent or habitual basis may be treated as a disciplinary issue and may be adjusted against applicable leave or salary, at management's discretion.

4.6 Public Holidays – 2026 (Updated)

- **January 1** – New Year
- **January 26** – Republic Day
- **March 20** – Eid-ul-Fitr (tentative)
- **April 3** – Good Friday
- **April 15** – Vishu
- **May 1** – May Day (International Workers' Day)
- **June 26** – Muharram
- **Karkidaka Vavu** – **July / August** *(date as per calendar)*
- **August 15** – Independence Day
- **August 26** – Thiruvonam (Onam)
- **October 2** – Gandhi Jayanti
- **October 21** – Vijayadasami
- **November 8** – Diwali
- **December 25** – Christmas

(Exact dates for festival-based holidays will be communicated in advance.)

4.7 Work from Home (WFH) Policy

Paperplanes LLP follows a strictly **on-site** working model. Work-from-home is not an entitlement and may be considered only in rare and exceptional circumstances, at the sole discretion of management.

5. COMPENSATION & PAYROLL

- Salaries are credited on or before the **10th** of each month
- Salary increments are performance-based and not fixed
- The company does not provide Advance Salary/Loan

5.1 Reimbursement of Office Expenses:

Any amount spent from an employee's personal funds for company needs will be refunded within twenty (20) working days, subject to submission of valid proof (bills/receipts) and management approval.

6. PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT

Employee performance is reviewed on an ongoing basis through feedback, work quality, and contribution to company goals. Performance reviews may influence increments, role changes, or continued employment.

7. PREVENTION OF SEXUAL HARASSMENT (POSH) POLICY

Paperplanes LLP is committed to providing a safe and respectful workplace.

Sexual harassment includes unwelcome physical contact, inappropriate remarks, requests for favors, or any conduct creating an uncomfortable environment.

Complaints may be submitted in writing to HR or the Internal Complaints Committee (ICC). Confidentiality and fairness will be maintained. Appropriate disciplinary action will be taken if allegations are proven.

8. GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL

Employees are encouraged to raise workplace concerns in a respectful manner. –

- Step 1: Report to immediate reporting authority or HR
- Step 2: Escalation to management if unresolved

The company will aim to resolve grievances fairly and promptly.

9. INTERNSHIP & TRAINEE POLICY

- Internship duration: 3–6 months
- Internships may be paid or unpaid as communicated
- Internship does not guarantee permanent employment
- Interns must follow company rules and maintain confidentiality

10. CODE OF CONDUCT & GENERAL RULES

- Drugs, intoxicants, alcohol, and smoking are strictly prohibited at the workplace.
- Employees must not report to work under the influence of any intoxicating substance.
- Personal work during office hours or on company devices is not permitted.
- Visitors must be reported to the appropriate authority.
- Employees must accurately record attendance.
- Violation of company policies may lead to disciplinary action.

10.1 **Confidentiality & Safeguarding of Company Information**

- Employees shall not retain, copy, store, or keep any company documents, data, client information, or confidential material on personal devices or systems, either during or after employment, unless expressly authorized by management.
- All company information must be used strictly for official purposes and stored only on company-approved systems.
- Upon request or on exit, employees must return or permanently delete all company data in their possession. Any violation of this policy will be treated as a serious misconduct and may lead to disciplinary action, including termination and/or legal action.

11. ELECTRONIC DEVICE POLICY

- Company-provided devices are for **official use only** and remain **company property**.
- **Personal work or personal use is not permitted** on company devices.
- Employees are responsible for the **safety and proper use** of assigned devices.
- Devices must be **password-protected**; unauthorised software installation is prohibited.
- Any **technical issues or damage** must be reported promptly.
- Devices must be **returned upon exit or transfer**.
- Company electrical resources must be **used responsibly**.

12. TERMINATION OF EMPLOYMENT & NOTICE PERIOD

12.1 During Probation-

- Either party (the Company or the Employee) may terminate the employment /with immediate effect or by giving 7/15 days written notice or salary I in lieu of notice, at the Company's discretion.
- The Company reserves the right to terminate employment immediately during probation in cases of unsatisfactory performance, behavioral concerns, misconduct, violation of company policies, or any other justifiable reason.

12.2 After Confirmation

- Upon successful completion of probation, the employee's services will be confirmed in writing.
- Post-confirmation, either party may terminate the employment by giving 30/60 days prior written notice or salary in lieu of notice.
- Notwithstanding the above, the Company reserves the right to terminate employment with immediate effect at any time in cases of:
    - Gross misconduct
    - Fraud or dishonesty
    - Breach of confidentiality
    - Behavioral issues causing disruption to the workplace
    - Violation of company policies

- Consistently poor or unsatisfactory performance despite feedback and guidance

12.3 Full & Final Settlement

- On termination, the employee will be paid salary up to the last working day, along with any other dues as per applicable laws and company policies, after adjusting recoveries (If any).
- All company property must be returned before final settlement is processed.
- The final settlement will be processed in the payroll cycle following the employee's last working day.

13. EMPLOYEE ENGAGEMENT & TEAM CULTURE

The company promotes a positive work culture by hosting the following:

- Office Trips
  - An annual two-day office trip may be organized.
- Team Lunches
  - Team lunches may be conducted 4–6 times a year.
- Special Celebrations
  - Culturally significant occasions such as Onam, Christmas, and Nombuthura (Ramadan/Iftar) may be observed.

14. POLICY AMENDMENT

Management reserves the right to amend this handbook at any time. Employees are responsible for staying informed about updates.

15. EMPLOYEE SELF-DECLARATION STATEMENT

I, employed at **Paperplanes LLP**, hereby acknowledge that I have received, read, and understood the Employee Policy Handbook.

I declare that:

1. I have read and understood the policies, procedures, rules, and regulations mentioned in the handbook.
2. I agree to abide by the terms and conditions outlined during the course of my employment.
3. I understand that the policies may be amended by management from time to time.
4. I understand that non-compliance with these policies may result in disciplinary action, including termination.
5. I understand that the final settlement will be processed in the subsequent payroll cycle following my last working day.

Employee Name :

Employee ID :

Designation :

Date :

Signature :

Place :